Install VS Code

Digital Technologies · Personal computers

You will

- download and install Visual Studio Code (VS Code)
- choose the right options while it installs
- open VS Code for the first time

You need

- a Windows computer you're allowed to install apps on (Chromebooks can't run VS Code)

Before you start

- On school computers VS Code is already installed: see the guide Open a project folder in VS Code.
- Install VS Code before Git, so Git can use it.

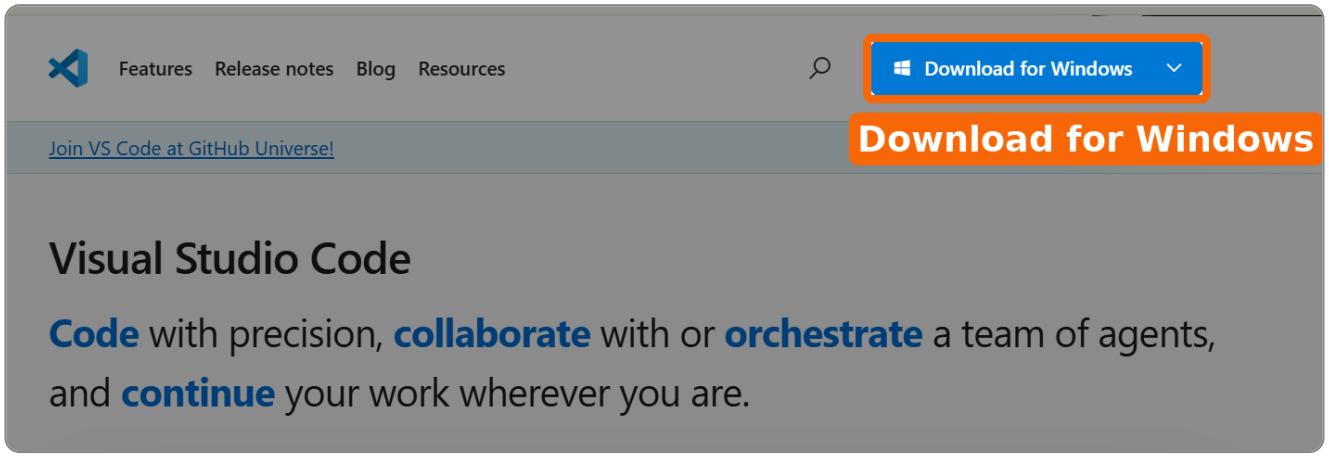
 Click here  Look here

1

Chrome › code.visualstudio.com

Go to `code.visualstudio.com`.

Click **Download for Windows**.



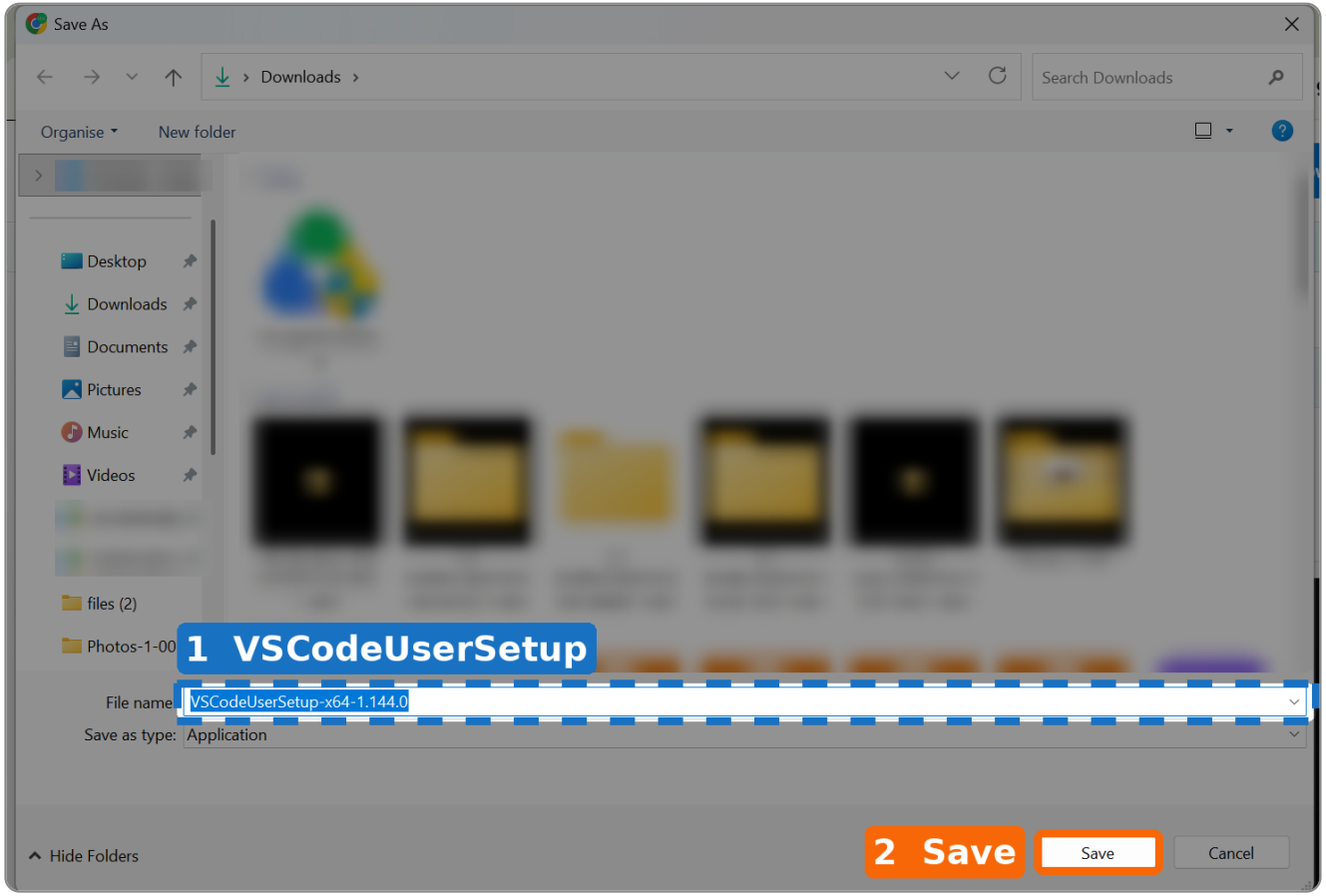
2

Chrome › Save As › only if it opens

Leave the name as it is.

Click **Save**.

Most computers skip this window and download straight away.



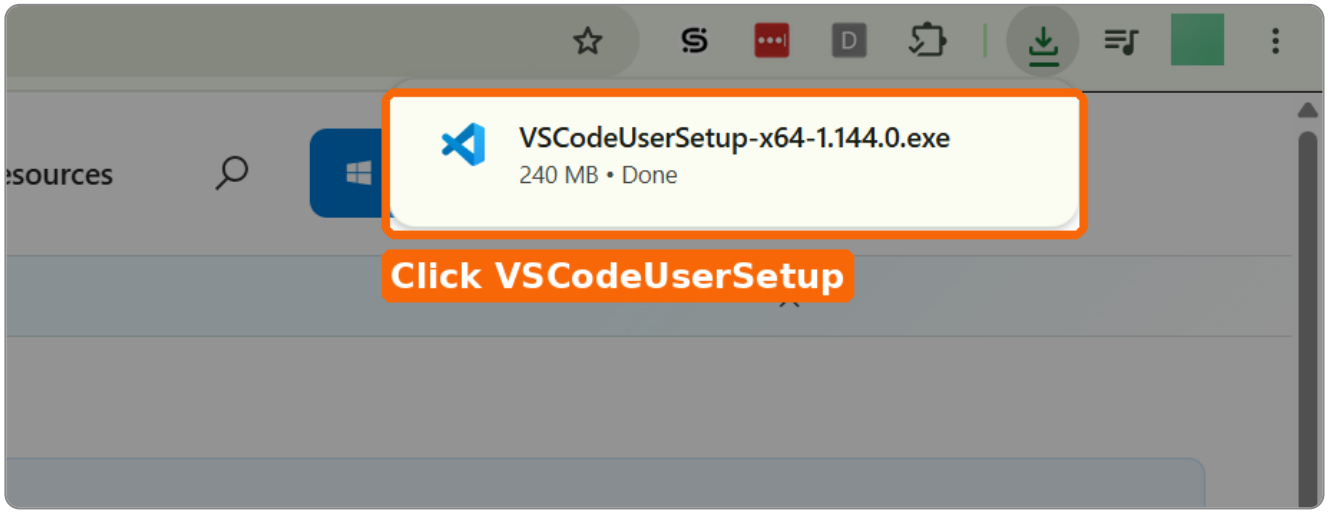
3

Chrome › Downloads

When it says Done, click the `VSCodeUserSetup` file.

If Windows asks whether to allow the app to make changes, click **Yes**.

Can't see it? Press `Ctrl` + `J` to open your downloads.



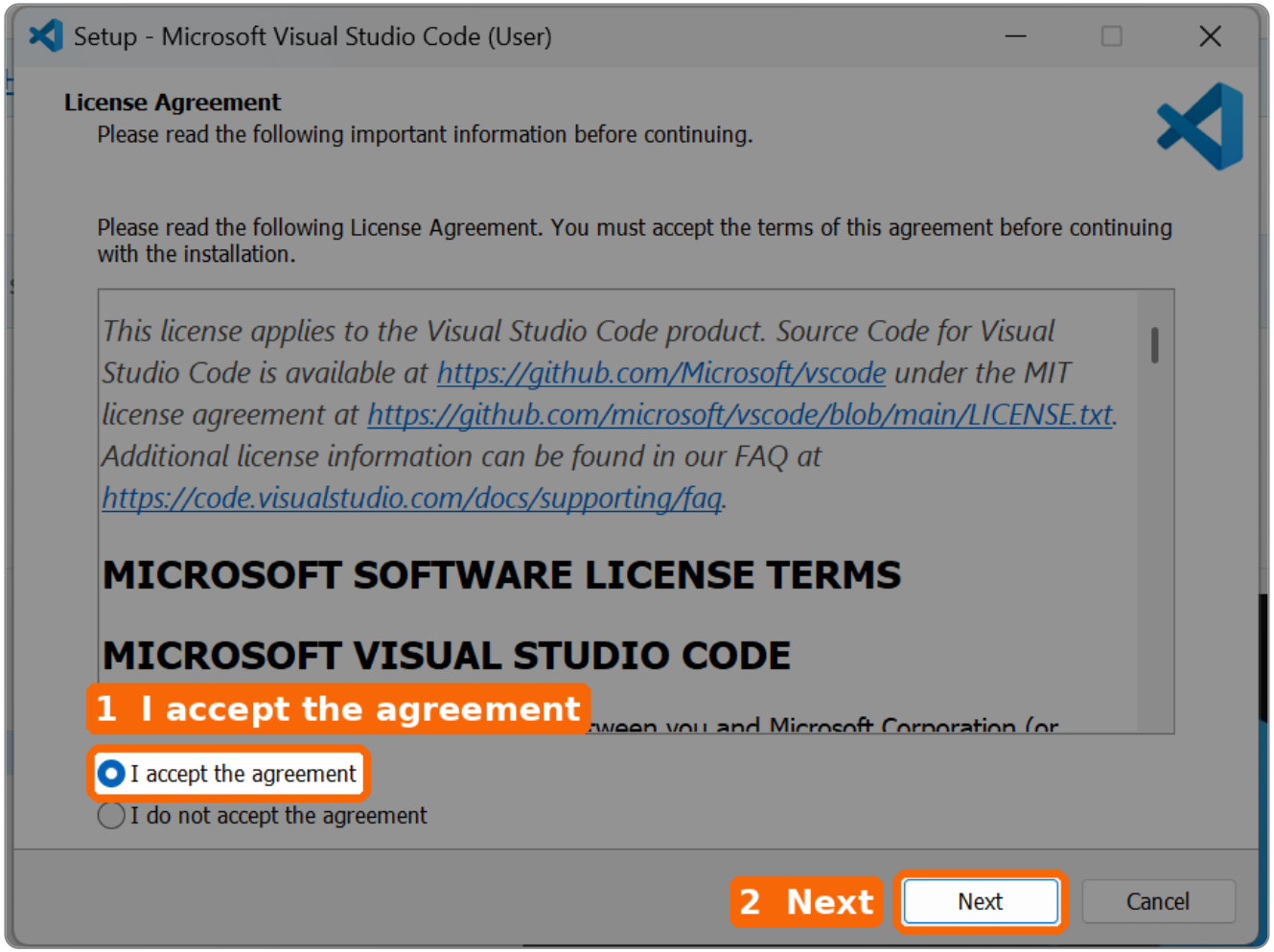
4

Setup › License Agreement

Click **I accept the agreement**.

Click **Next**.

Click **Next** on any screen this guide doesn't show, leaving it as it is.



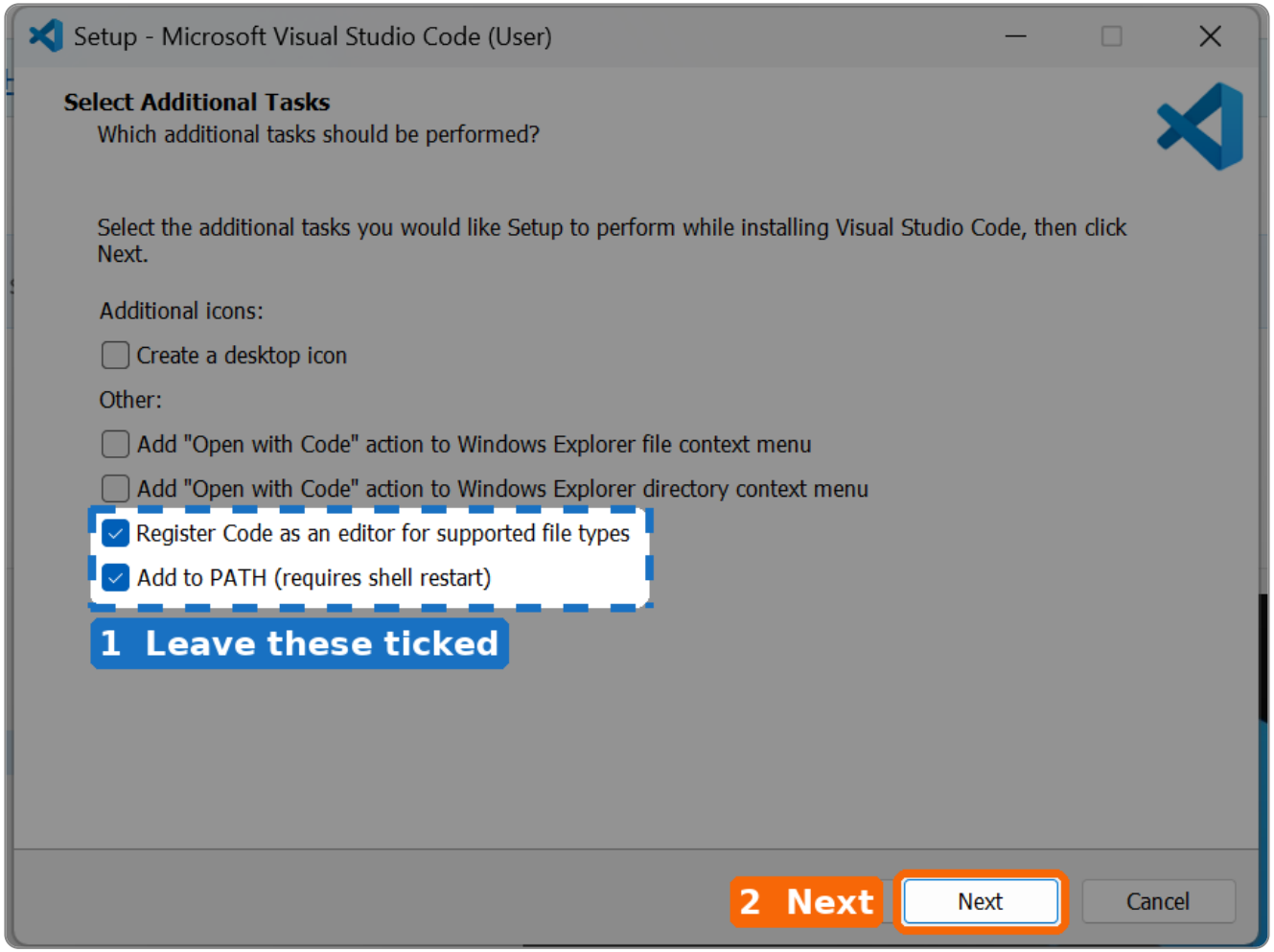
5

Setup › Select Additional Tasks

Leave **Register Code as an editor** and **Add to PATH** ticked.

Click **Next**.

Optional: tick both **Add "Open with Code"** boxes to open folders from File Explorer's right-click menu.



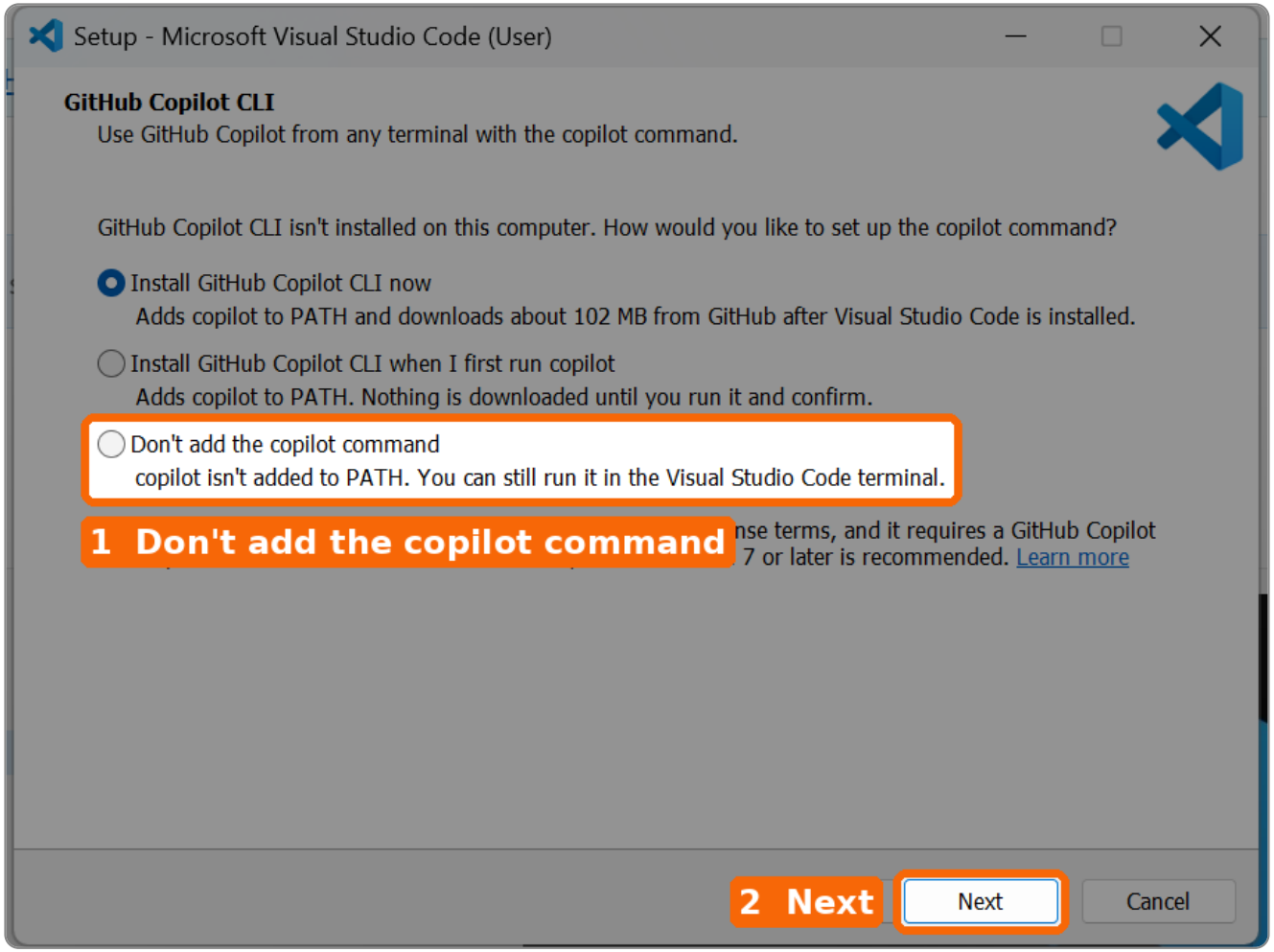
6

Setup › GitHub Copilot CLI

Click **Don't add the copilot command**.

Click **Next**.

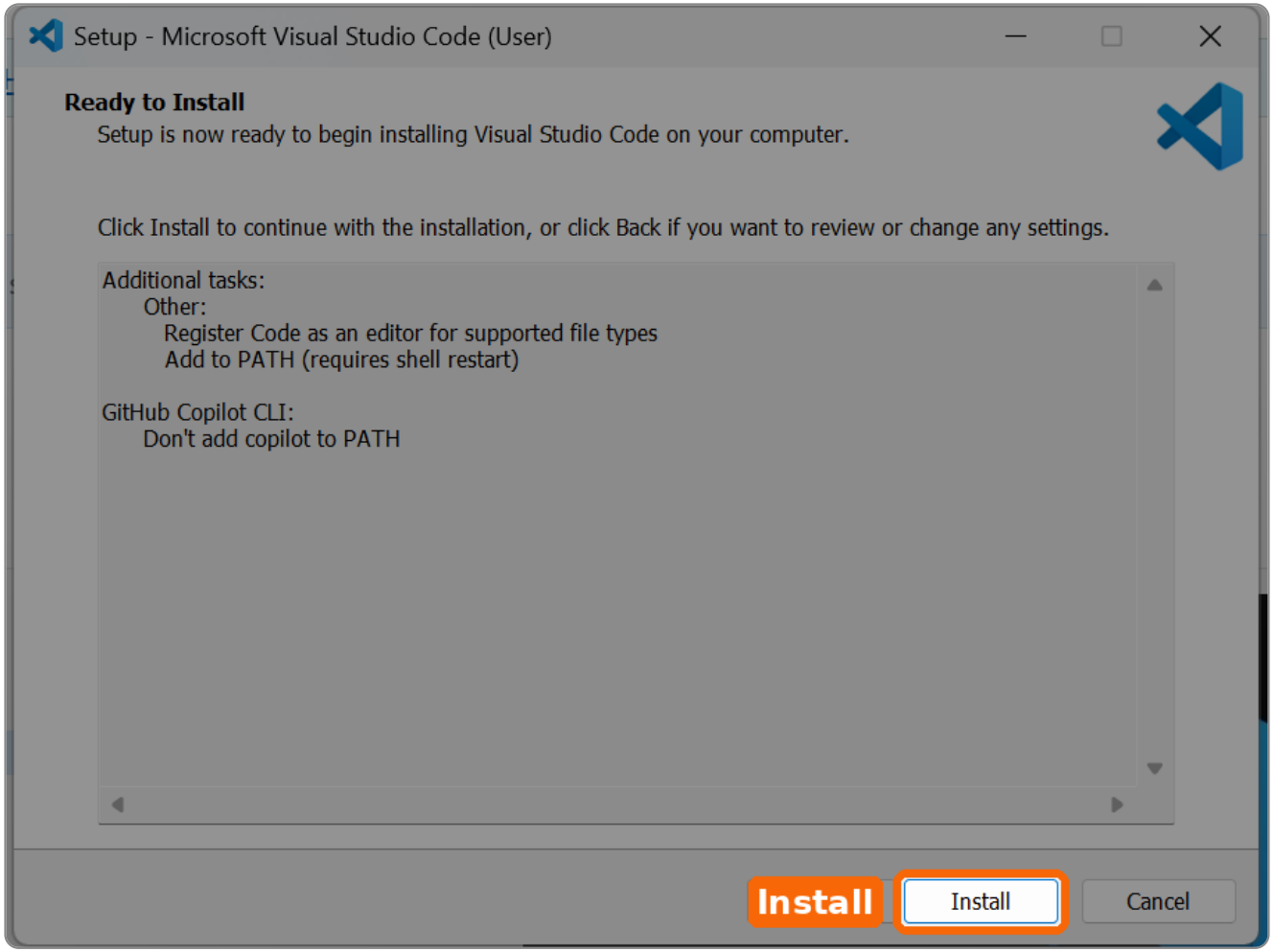
Copilot is an AI tool. Use AI only when your kaiako says you can.



7

Setup › Ready to Install

Click **Install**.

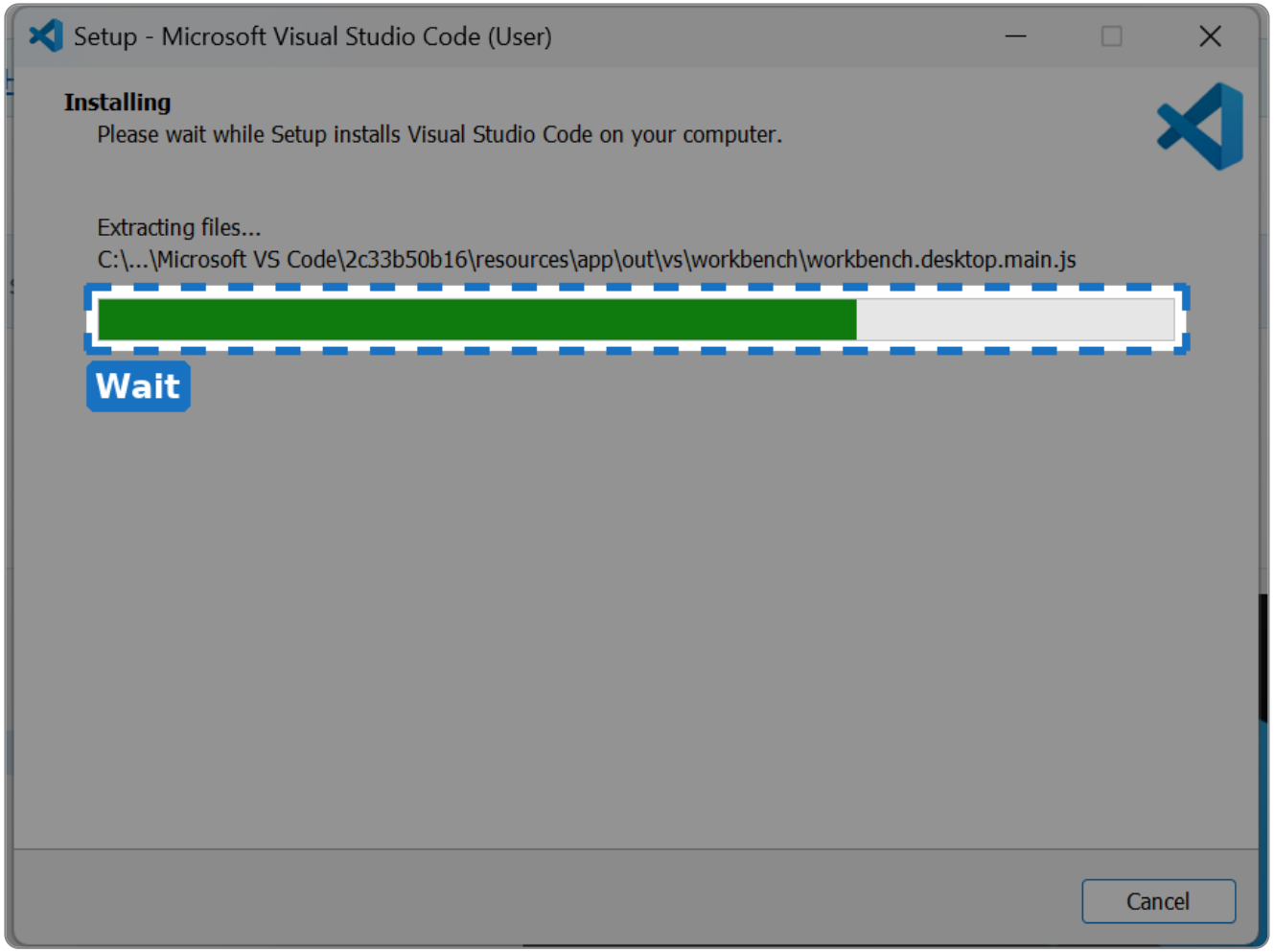


8

Setup › Installing

Wait while it installs.

This takes a minute or two.

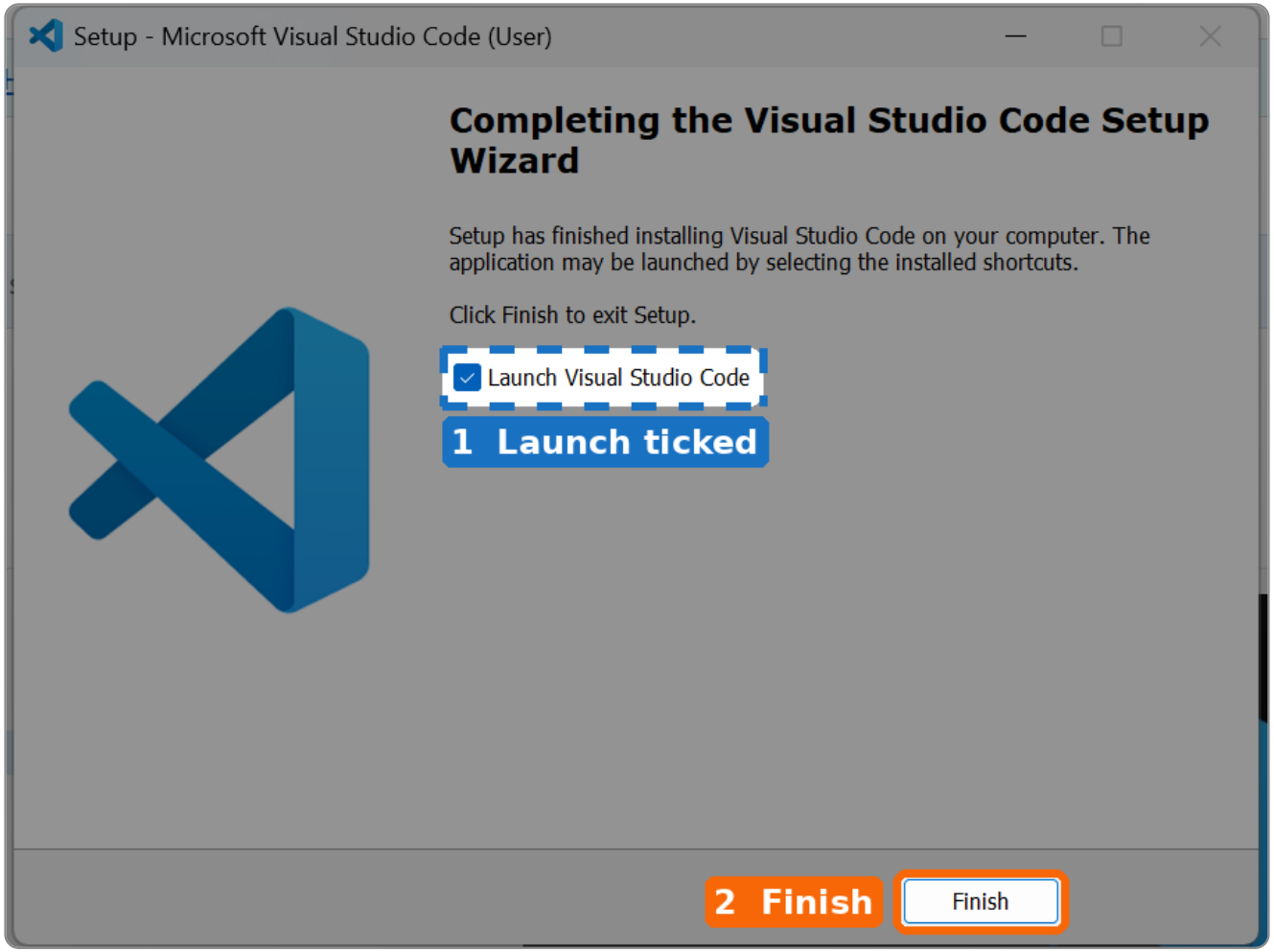


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Setup › Completing Setup

Leave **Launch Visual Studio Code** ticked.

Click **Finish**.



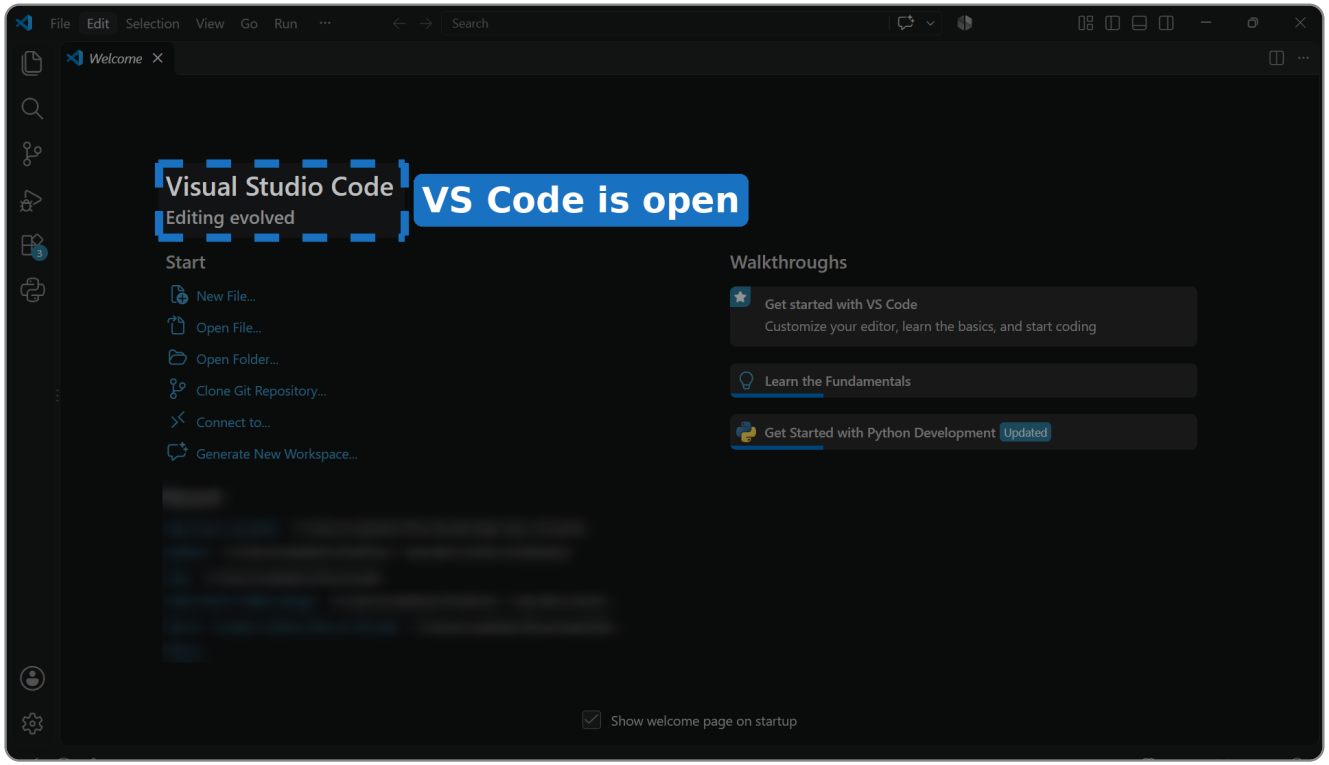
10

VS Code › Welcome

VS Code opens on its Welcome page.

Your Recent list starts empty. It fills up as you open folders.

> **Check:** the Welcome page with Start and Walkthroughs.



Finding it again

Start › type code › click Visual Studio Code. Right-click it in the taskbar and choose Pin to taskbar to keep it there.

Next

Open your project folder (see the guide Open a project folder in VS Code) and add extensions (see the guide Install VS Code extensions).

Checkpoint

- [ ] I can download and install VS Code.
- [ ] I chose not to add the copilot command.
- [ ] VS Code opens on my computer.